

CJ Libassi

Senior Research Associate, PEER Center, American University

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EDUCATION

Teachers College, Columbia University PhD in Economics and Education	September 2021–May 2026
University of Michigan, Ford School of Public Policy Master of Public Policy	September 2013–May 2015
American University Master of Arts in Teaching	August 2010–August 2012
University of Scranton Bachelor of Arts in English, Spanish, and Philosophy	September 2006–May 2010

PUBLICATIONS AND WORKS IN PROGRESS

Publications

- Susan Dynarski, CJ Libassi, Katherine Michelmore, and Stephanie Owen. “Closing the Gap: The Effect of Reducing Complexity and Uncertainty in College Pricing on the Choices of Low-Income Students” *American Economic Review*, 2021
- Zachary Mabel, CJ Libassi, and Michael Hurwitz. “The value of using early-career earnings data in the College Scorecard to guide college choices” *Economics of Education Review*, 2020

Working Papers

- Elizabeth Burland, Nora Delaney, Susan Dynarski, Katherine B. Leu, CJ Libassi, Katherine Michelmore, Stephanie Owen, Mary A. Quiroga, and Elizabeth Salinas. “Degrees of Mobility: Shifting Low-Income Students to Higher Quality Colleges”, *NBER Working Paper No. 35434*, July 2026
- Judith Scott-Clayton, Veronica Minaya, CJ Libassi, and Joshua K.R. Thomas. “Who Rides Out the Storm? The Immediate Post-College Transition and its Role in Socioeconomic Earnings Gaps”, *NBER Working Paper No. 34366*, October 2025
- CJ Libassi, Michel Grosz, Sophie McGuinness, Jordan Matsudaira, and Rajeev Darolia. “An Overview of Graduate Borrowing and Outcomes”, *OCE Working Paper No. OCE2024-007*, US Department of Education, January 2025

Works in Progress

- CJ Libassi. “Pell Away from the Cutoffs: A Simulated Instrument Approach to Estimating the Effects of the Pell Grant from Changes in Formula Generosity Over Time”

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

PEER Center, American University Senior Research Associate	May 2026–Present Washington
US Department of Education, Office of the Chief Economist Senior Advisor and Federation of American Scientists Impact Fellow	May 2022–January 2024 New York
Community College Research Center Senior Research Assistant	June 2021–May 2026 Washington
College Board Senior Policy Research Analyst	April 2018–March 2021 Washington
George Washington University Professorial Lecturer	January 2018–May 2021

Center for American Progress	Washington
Policy Analyst	July 2016–April 2018
Education Policy Initiative, University of Michigan	Ann Arbor
Research Area Specialist	May 2015–June 2016
Comunidad de Madrid	Madrid
Fulbright English Teaching Assistant	September 2012–June 2013
Prince George’s County Public Schools	Upper Marlboro
Foreign Language Teacher / Teach For America Corps Member	June 2010–June 2012

SELECTED OTHER WRITING

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- CJ Libassi and Julia Turner. “Debt and Earnings in Graduate School: Moving Beyond Standard Measures for the Typical Student in the Short Term.” PSEO Coalition, 2025.
 - CJ Libassi and Zachary Mabel. “A Closer Look at College Affordability: The Link between Living Allowances and Student Debt.” Urban Institute, 2022.
 - Judith Scott-Clayton, CJ Libassi, and Daniel Sparks. “The Fine Print on Free College: Who Benefits from New York’s Excelsior Scholarship? An Essay for the Learning Curve.” Urban Institute, 2022.
 - Jennifer Ma, Matea Pender, CJ Libassi, and Sandy Baum. “Trends in College Pricing and Trends in Student Aid.” College Board, 2018, 2019, 2020.
 - CJ Libassi. “The Neglected College Race Gap: Racial Disparities Among College Completers.” Center for American Progress, 2018.
 - Ben Miller and CJ Libassi. “Sharing the Risk: A Plan for Colleges to Participate in the Costs of Student Loan Failure.” Center for American Progress, 2016.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

George Washington University	Washington, DC
<i>Professorial Lecturer, Data Analysis for Journalism and Political Communication</i>	Spring 2018–2021

FELLOWSHIPS

Institute of Education Sciences Predoctoral Training Grant, PEAR Fellowship	2021–2025
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INVITED PRESENTATIONS AND CONFERENCES

2025: APPAM Fall Research Conference (Seattle, WA), MidSouth Education Policy Workshop; **2024:** Office of the Chief Economist Conference, US Department of Education (Washington, DC); **2021:** Association for Education Finance and Policy (AEFP); **2020:** Society of Government Economists (SGE); **2019:** APPAM Fall Research Conference; **2018:** Southern Economic Association (SEA)

SERVICE

Referee: *Economics of Education Review*, *Journal of Benefit-Cost Analysis*, *Journal of Public Economics*, *Social Science Review*

Co-organizer: DC Economics of Education Seminar Series (2017–2019)

SKILLS

Languages: Fluent in Spanish

Software: Stata, R, Python, SQL, SAS, Excel

GRANTS RECEIVED

2025: PSEO Coalition Research Grant: “Debt and Earnings in Graduate School: Moving Beyond Standard Measures for the Typical Student in the Short Term” (Co-Principal Investigator with Julia Turner), \$15,000